

Rooms

By Jason Hayward

““Why do you call me ‘Lord, Lord,’ and not do what I tell you?”
Luke 6:46

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Introduction

When new believers pray to receive Jesus Christ and God's salvation into their life, they are directed to receive Him as both Savior and Lord. The latter should be a commitment to a process of change. It requires repentance, a complete change of mind. We must continually reorient ourselves to God, day by day, until Jesus Christ is actually Lord over us. After all, we are only truly set free when we have relinquished control over our lives to Christ. We can only experience the life that God has for us in Christ when we have died to our old self first. The new disciple that has Christ as Lord should be able to say to new believers, as the Apostle Paul did, "Be ye followers of, even as I am also of Christ" (1 Corinthians 11:1, KJV). Until you are able to say that to new believers, including ones that you have led into discipleship, you and God have some work yet to do with yourself.

The disciples found themselves in this situation, until they had received the Holy Spirit at Pentecost. I also find myself in this situation, needing to give myself over to God completely. So this is a walk I plan to make along with you.

As Christ followers, we know that God wants all of us; it's the nature of the greatest commandment, according to Jesus (Mark 12:29-30). Further, Jesus instructed His disciples that He is the vine and they are the branches (John 15:1-16). As branches to the vine, Jesus' command to us is "Abide in me" (John 15:4). *To abide is to settle down into and make oneself at home in.* Jesus Christ does this in us through the gift of the Holy Spirit that He gave to His disciples: those who obey Him (Acts 2:38-39, Acts 5:32). If we do not have the Spirit of Christ, we do not belong to God (Romans 8:8-9).

Have you made the Holy Spirit feel welcome to settle down in you? Consider your full life to be a home. Can God make Himself at home in you, day in and day out? Can the Spirit go anywhere in you? Do anything? Or are there some rooms there that are still really yours? (God knows.)

This book walks us through ten different rooms in our lives over which we may have difficulty releasing control to the Lordship of Christ. The aim is to bring these rooms into the light. Until anything comes into the light, we cannot call it what it is nor separate it from ourselves.

Further, it is important that the names we call God, especially Lord, are true to their meaning, so that we don't miss the good relationship and the abundant life He has for us; or so that God does not one day tell us He did not know us (Matthew 7:21-23, Luke

13:23-27). He is Yahweh, Jehovah, and Adonai; our Lord and Master. He is the Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the end.

It's time to invite God to abide in us.

Family

Family is a blessing from God. We need care, we need lifelong community, and we need belonging. We need to be known.

Yet, we also must be careful about elevating what is good – or even very good – to too high of a position in our lives.

Ultimately we were made for the family of God, which includes the children of God (John 1:12, Romans 8:14). Many of us have difficulty changing our thinking to widen what we consider to be our family though.

When it comes to our biological families, Jesus has some difficult-to-hear teaching regarding discipleship for us to believe and to put into practice:

““Do not think that I have come to bring peace to the earth. I have not come to bring peace, but a sword. For I have come to set a man against his father, and a daughter against her mother, and a daughter-in-law against her mother-in-law. And a person’s enemies will be those of his own household. Whoever loves father or mother more than me is not worthy of me, and whoever loves son or daughter more than me is not worthy of me. And whoever does not take his cross and follow me is not worthy of me. Whoever finds his life will lose it, and whoever loses his life for my sake will find it.”

Matthew 10:34-39 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.10.34-39.ESV>

“As they were going along the road, someone said to him, “I will follow you wherever you go.” And Jesus said to him, “Foxes have holes, and birds of the air have nests, but the Son of Man has nowhere to lay his head.” To another he said, “Follow me.” But he said, “Lord, let me first go and bury my father.” And Jesus said to him, “Leave the dead to bury their own dead. But as for you, go and proclaim the kingdom of God.” Yet another said, “I will follow you, Lord, but let me first say farewell to those at my home.” Jesus said to him, “No one who puts his hand to the plow and looks back is fit for the kingdom of God.””

Luke 9:57-62 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.9.57-62.ESV>

“Now great crowds accompanied him, and he turned and said to them, “If anyone comes to me and does not hate his own father and mother and wife and children and brothers and sisters, yes, and even his own life, he cannot be my disciple. Whoever does not bear his own cross and come after me cannot be my disciple. For which of you, desiring to build a tower, does not first sit down and count the cost, whether he has

enough to complete it? Otherwise, when he has laid a foundation and is not able to finish, all who see it begin to mock him, saying, 'This man began to build and was not able to finish.' Or what king, going out to encounter another king in war, will not sit down first and deliberate whether he is able with ten thousand to meet him who comes against him with twenty thousand? And if not, while the other is yet a great way off, he sends a delegation and asks for terms of peace. So therefore, any one of you who does not renounce all that he has cannot be my disciple."

Luke 14:25-33 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.14.25-33.ESV>

Jesus' call to disciples has not changed. Considering the worldwide family of believers, our family members may oppose us choosing to follow Jesus Christ. Some of us may be severely or even violently opposed by family.¹

Or family may oppose what Christ calls us to in discipleship. The cost of discipleship is high, and, as we walk the path Jesus walked, we throw off the person we used to be in the process of becoming like Jesus Christ. Further, discipleship changes our first love. It changes who we live to please (see also Galatians 1:10, 1 Corinthians 7:33-35). It changes our attention and how we choose to spend our time, our treasure and our talent. Your creator (Elohim) is jealous (Qanna) for you.

Have you given over the room of your family to the Lordship of Jesus Christ?

God loves them more than you do. Further, we have His promise that whatever we desire for the glory of God, Christ will do it (John 14:13).

Do you trust God with your family enough to let Him have His way?

When it comes to your family, open your hands to God and release them.

¹ If you have lost your family or even all your family and friends to follow Christ, know that God is Immanuel, or "God with us" to you, and He will give you a new family of other disciples.

Reputation

Reputation has to do with our identity and our character. It's how our world sees us and thinks about us, and it's also our perception of how they do. Most people are proud of who they are, the family they come from, the town or city they live in, and even their country of origin. We want other people to think well of us.

Since the spiritual world is also real, our reputation extends to how God and the heavenly host see us and how God's enemies perceive us.

If you are a follower of Jesus Christ and a child of God, this is now the most important part of your identity. You must make it known. God is Jehovah Nissi, the Lord our banner. It's time to visibly wave that flag as you march forward in new life!

You are to be baptized as a disciple in the name of the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit (Matthew 28:19-20). You are to give testimony (Luke 8:13-17, Acts 1:8) and to preach the gospel (Mark 13:10, Matthew 24:14, Luke 9:60), in obedience to the commands of Christ to his disciples.

What Jesus said to His disciples, He also says to you:

"So everyone who acknowledges me before men, I also will acknowledge before my Father who is in heaven, but whoever denies me before men, I also will deny before my Father who is in heaven."

Matthew 10:32-33 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.10.32-33.ESV>

Have you given over the room of your reputation to the Lordship of Jesus Christ?

How does God see you, based upon the words you speak and your obedience to His commands? If you are His, His Spirit lives in you, knowing your thoughts, words, and deeds. Do the angels that attend you (Hebrews 1:14) know you are steadfastly committed to God?

How does the devil and those who are his see you? What reputation have you made for yourself based on all that you say and do on a day to day basis? Are you a threat to that thief's interests and domain?

Do you trust God with your reputation enough to let Him have His way?

When it comes to your reputation, open your hands to God and release it.

Sexuality

Sexuality is a blessing of God from the beginning of man's creation:

"Therefore a man shall leave his father and his mother and hold fast to his wife, and they shall become one flesh. And the man and his wife were both naked and were not ashamed."

Genesis 2:24-25 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/gen.2.24-25.ESV>

Yet, as children of God, nothing good God that gave to us is to be exalted above His Lordship or misused. If you are Christ's, you are now joined to God:

"But he who is joined to the Lord becomes one spirit with him. Flee from sexual immorality. Every other sin a person commits is outside the body, but the sexually immoral person sins against his own body. Or do you not know that your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit within you, whom you have from God? You are not your own, for you were bought with a price. So glorify God in your body."

1 Corinthians 6:17-20 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1co.6.17-20.ESV>

You are directly connected to God via your spirit! Your body is a temple of God's Holy Spirit, so you must be holy, or set apart from the world unto God. Further, you are empowered to be holy, for Christ lives in you (Colossians 1:27), and you have His mind (1 Corinthians 2:16).

Remember what Jesus taught about our thoughts:

"'You have heard that it was said, 'You shall not commit adultery.' But I say to you that everyone who looks at a woman with lustful intent has already committed adultery with her in his heart."

Matthew 5:27-28 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.5.27-28.ESV>

Scripture also says:

"Do not present your members to sin as instruments for unrighteousness, but present yourselves to God as those who have been brought from death to life, and your members to God as instruments for righteousness."

Romans 6:13 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rom.6.13.ESV>

Continuing to look at a person you are not married to with lustful intent, beyond the initial temptation, is sin. Any kind of fornication is sin. Pornography is sin. Masturbation

is sin. Whatever does not proceed from faith is sin (Romans 14:23), thereby leading to separation from God, slavery, and death. Sin also suppresses the truth in us (Matthew 13:15, Romans 1:18-32), so beware that justifying what you want may come easily. Further, today we can easily find teachers to suit our own passions speaking words we want to hear (Matthew 7:15-23, 2 Timothy 4:3-4).

We must be careful what we choose to take in and what we choose to think on (Philippians 4:8-9). As those who call Christ Lord, we are to cooperate with God's indwelling Spirit in the renewing of our minds (Romans 12:1-2, Ephesians 4:22-23, Colossians 3:8-9) to conform with the perfect blueprint of the word of God, however long it takes. If we are serious about it, it happens much more quickly. Most are not, and wide is the road that leads to destruction (Matthew 7:13-23).

Only consensual sex between a married man and woman is blessed by God, for they are one flesh in His sight. Jesus also spoke words about marrying more than once that should be examined seriously (Matthew 19:3-12).

This is what scripture says about you:

"For our sake he made him to be sin who knew no sin, so that in him we might become the righteousness of God."

2 Corinthians 5:21 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2co.5.21.ESV>

You are the righteousness of God; you have made right in Christ. Righteousness is a lifestyle that produces victory in every situation. Jesus Christ led such a life, and Christ lives in you. He is Jehovah Tsidkenu, the Lord our Righteousness. He is Jehovah Mekoddishkem, the Lord who sanctifies you.

Do you want the freedom and life and victory that Christ died to give you? Do you believe what He did is enough for you?

Have you given over the room of your sexuality to the Lordship of Jesus Christ?

When it comes to your sexuality, open your hands to God and release it to Him.

Finances

Prosperity is a blessing from God from the beginning of man's creation, when Adam and Eve were given dominion over the earth (Genesis 1:26-30). Further, God gives blessing (berâkâh, H1293) and peace (shâlôm, H7965) to His people that obey Him (Deuteronomy 28:1-13, Joshua 1:7-8, Psalm 29:11). The meanings of the words for blessing and peace both include prosperity.

However, Jesus Christ warned that money can easily become a master, and ““““No one can serve two masters, for either he will hate the one and love the other, or he will be devoted to the one and despise the other. You cannot serve God and money.”

Matthew 6:24 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.6.24.ESV>

Jesus rebuked His church at Laodicea, calling them to repentance because of their love of money:

““““I know your works: you are neither cold nor hot. Would that you were either cold or hot! So, because you are lukewarm, and neither hot nor cold, I will spit you out of my mouth. For you say, I am rich, I have prospered, and I need nothing, not realizing that you are wretched, pitiable, poor, blind, and naked. I counsel you to buy from me gold refined by fire, so that you may be rich, and white garments so that you may clothe yourself and the shame of your nakedness may not be seen, and salve to anoint your eyes, so that you may see. Those whom I love, I reprove and discipline, so be zealous and repent. Behold, I stand at the door and knock. If anyone hears my voice and opens the door, I will come in to him and eat with him, and he with me.”

Revelation 3:15-20 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rev.3.15-20.ESV>

Jesus, calling a would-be disciple to maturity, “... said to him, “If you would be perfect, go, sell what you possess and give to the poor, and you will have treasure in heaven; and come, follow me.” When the young man heard this he went away sorrowful, for he had great possessions. And Jesus said to his disciples, “Truly, I say to you, only with difficulty will a rich person enter the kingdom of heaven. Again I tell you, it is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle than for a rich person to enter the kingdom of God.” When the disciples heard this, they were greatly astonished, saying, “Who then can be saved?” But Jesus looked at them and said, “With man this is impossible, but with God all things are possible.” Then Peter said in reply, “See, we have left everything and followed you. What then will we have?” Jesus said to them, “Truly, I say to you, in the new world, when the Son of Man will sit on his glorious throne, you who have followed me will also sit on twelve thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel. And

everyone who has left houses or brothers or sisters or father or mother or children or lands, for my name's sake, will receive a hundredfold and will inherit eternal life. But many who are first will be last, and the last first."

Matthew 19:21-30 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.19.21-30.ESV>

Jesus commanded His disciples to abandon their wealth and follow Him, promising they would be rewarded with prosperity in the kingdom of heaven. Jesus also taught, "Give to everyone who begs from you, and from one who takes away your goods do not demand them back. And as you wish that others would do to you, do so to them."

Luke 6:30-31 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.6.30-31.ESV>

In the early church in Jerusalem, the culture was such that "...no one said that any of the things that belonged to him was his own, but they had everything in common... There was not a needy person among them, for as many as were owners of lands or houses sold them and brought the proceeds of what was sold and laid it at the apostles' feet, and it was distributed to each as any had need."

Acts 4:32-35 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/act.4.32-35.ESV>

The Apostle John tied generosity to love:

"But if anyone has the world's goods and sees his brother in need, yet closes his heart against him, how does God's love abide in him? Little children, let us not love in word or talk but in deed and in truth."

1 John 3:17-18 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1jn.3.17-18.ESV>

The Apostle Paul taught the Corinthian church, "The point is this: whoever sows sparingly will also reap sparingly, and whoever sows bountifully will also reap bountifully. Each one must give as he has decided in his heart, not reluctantly or under compulsion, for God loves a cheerful giver. And God is able to make all grace abound to you, so that having all sufficiency in all things at all times, you may abound in every good work. As it is written, "He has distributed freely, he has given to the poor; his righteousness endures forever." He who supplies seed to the sower and bread for food will supply and multiply your seed for sowing and increase the harvest of your righteousness. You will be enriched in every way to be generous in every way, which through us will produce thanksgiving to God. For the ministry of this service is not only supplying the needs of the saints but is also overflowing in many thanksgivings to God. By their approval of this service, they will glorify God because of your submission that comes from your

confession of the gospel of Christ, and the generosity of your contribution for them and for all others,”

2 Corinthians 9:6-13 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/2co.9.6-13.ESV>

In his letter to 1 Timothy, Paul instructed Timothy, who oversaw the church at Ephesus: “As for the rich in this present age, charge them not to be haughty, nor to set their hopes on the uncertainty of riches, but on God, who richly provides us with everything to enjoy. They are to do good, to be rich in good works, to be generous and ready to share, thus storing up treasure for themselves as a good foundation for the future, so that they may take hold of that which is truly life.”

1 Timothy 6:17-19 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1ti.6.17-19.ESV>

The teaching of the early apostles was that the prosperity God will bring to us (3 John 1:2) is to be shared and given freely. There is reward to come for our obedience, especially in the coming ages (1 Corinthians 3:11-15, Ephesians 2:7).

Is the way you steward the money God has entrusted to you consistent with you calling Jesus Christ your Lord?

Be warned. The modern teaching of prosperity theology is a tradition of man that makes void the word of God and causes vain worship of God (Matthew 15:6-9).

When Christ is our Lord, we should really not concern ourselves with finances (Matthew 6:25-32). Instead, we are to remember who we are to our Father:

“...‘Son, you are always with me, and all that is mine is yours.’”

Luke 15:31 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.15.31.ESV>

We are to believe God’s promise:

“And my God will supply every need of yours according to his riches in glory in Christ Jesus.”

Philippians 4:19 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/php.4.19.ESV>

We are to stand on God’s word, expecting our needs to be met at the moment we need it. He is Jehovah Jireh, the Lord will provide.

So when we need something, we should thank Him that we have it, then expect it to show up.

When it comes to the needs of others that we take responsibility for, either we can meet their needs, or, if we are unable, we can stand on God's word for their needs. God is trustworthy.

When it comes to things that we want *for the glory of God*, we can expect God to answer our prayers as well:

"Whatever you ask in my name, this I will do, that the Father may be glorified in the Son."

John 14:13 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.14.13.ESV>

When asking, we must check our motives, as James warned:

"You ask and do not receive, because you ask wrongly, to spend it on your passions."

James 4:3 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jas.4.3.ESV>

Have you given over the room of your finances to the Lordship of Jesus Christ?

When it comes to your finances, open your hands to God and release it to Him.

Health

Health is God's good design for the body, for God is life (1 John 5:11-12). If there had been no sin in the world, there would be no sickness, infirmity, disability or death. These come from an absence of life.

According to the Apostle Peter's words that summarized Jesus' ministry, such conditions are the oppression of the devil, and Jesus came to deliver us from it: "...God anointed Jesus of Nazareth with the Holy Spirit and with power. He went about doing good and healing all who were oppressed by the devil, for God was with him."

Acts 10:38 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/act.10.38.ESV>

As things are, God wants to be known to us as Jehovah Rapha (Exodus 15:26), the Lord that heals you. His will is to heal, and it's His nature to make things right. God wants us to know God's salvation as King David knew it:

"Bless the Lord, O my soul, and forget not all his benefits, who forgives all your iniquity, who heals all your diseases,"

Psalms 103:2-3 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.103.2-3.ESV>

We are to trust in the Lord for our help, for "It is better to take refuge in the Lord than to trust in man."

Psalms 118:8 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.118.8.ESV>

The more we can depend on God as He desires to be trusted, the more God will be glorified, the more our faith will be strengthened, and the more the devil will be put to open shame in defeat (Colossians 2:14-15). Further, there is no limit to His power, which we should be careful not to deny (2 Timothy 3:5).

This does require that we stand firm on the promise of God's word (Matthew 9:29, Matthew 17:19-20, Mark 9:23, Romans 8:2, 1 Peter 2:24) until we persevere², or that another believer who is able to stand firm on the promise of God's word lays hands on

² I am not suggesting it is easy to persevere, especially at first, and to obtain a reputation in the spiritual world as one who will not quit. Even Christ's own disciples struggled to persevere in faith, according to the gospels (e.g., Matthew 17:14-20), before the Holy Spirit had come upon them. Yet, our Lord Jesus Christ is to be our example, and He showed us the perfect example of boldness, compassion, and determination.

you (Mark 16:18) or prays the prayer³ of faith for you (James 5:15, Mark 11:24). To stand firm on God's word is to stand firm also on the fullness of the finished work of Jesus Christ; it's all a legal matter (Colossians 2:14-15, Revelation 12:10-11).

Alternatively, physicians and nurses can provide access to the benefits of medicine and care that allow for God's natural healing processes to take their course, yet this only requires faith in them rather than God. While medical staff are most often motivated by love for people and should be commended for their work, their abilities to help, considering the full breadth of possible health conditions, are nothing in comparison to the help of Jehovah Rapha. Jesus Christ, who has not changed (Hebrews 13:8), not only heals through repair (sometimes instantaneously); He also recreates things new as needed (e.g., Matthew 12:13, Luke 13:11-13) and raises from the dead.

When it comes to standing on the promise of God's word, Jesus modeled this best for us when He stood up to Satan three times when tempted in the desert, each time saying, "It is written" (Matthew 4:4,7,10). The last time, He added, "Be gone, Satan!" Jesus spoke to the mountain, telling it to move, and it did. Jesus said His disciples should have the same kind of faith:

"Truly, I say to you, whoever says to this mountain, 'Be taken up and thrown into the sea,' and does not doubt in his heart, but believes that what he says will come to pass, it will be done for him."

Mark 11:23 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mrk.11.23.ESV>

Have you given over the room of your health to the Lordship of Jesus Christ?

When it comes to your health, open your hands to God and release it to Him.

³ The word of prayer in "prayer of faith" is *euchē* (G2171), perhaps more correctly translated as vow. The one who prays for you must stand on God's word for you. It is Christ that has finished the work, as prophesied in Isaiah 53 and interpreted in Matthew 8:17.

Occupation

God has given us all time, energy, and attention. Our occupation is how we choose to spend our availability. It's the totality of how we choose to make ourselves busy.

If Jesus Christ is Lord, our occupation is to be doers of God's word, thereby bringing glory to God:

"But be doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving yourselves."

James 1:22 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jas.1.22.ESV>

Doing God's word is to be the vocation of every member of God's family, according to Jesus, who said:

"...“My mother and my brothers are those who hear the word of God and do it.””

Luke 8:21 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/luk.8.21.ESV>

Many of us spend time laboring to provide for our families, and this is right, according to scripture:

"But if anyone does not provide for his relatives, and especially for members of his household, he has denied the faith and is worse than an unbeliever."

1 Timothy 5:8 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/1ti.5.8.ESV>

Let's not be confused though; it's God that provides for us as His children (Matthew 6:25-32), and we are called as laborers of God (Matthew 9:37-38).

Those who are married spend time caring for their spouses, and this is right (Ephesians 5:21-33). Further, parents are to make disciples of their children, bringing them up in the discipline and instruction of the Lord (Deuteronomy 6:5-7, Proverbs 22:6, Ephesians 6:4).

Children are to honor their parents, just as Jesus did His mother. Jesus came not to do away with the Law and the Prophets, but to fulfill them.

Moreover, as those who have made Jesus our Lord, we are all to occupy our days with bearing fruit that brings glory to God:

"By this my Father is glorified, that you bear much fruit and so prove to be my disciples."

John 15:8 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.15.8.ESV>

The fruit God expects (Matthew 21:43) is both Christlike character in our own lives (Galatians 5:22-25), and it's the good works that naturally flow from such character. Our character develops toward Christlikeness as we cooperate with the Spirit that lives in us to renew our minds to God's word (Romans 12:2), which has to be accompanied by doing His word. Our faith is tested when we have opportunities to choose to do the thing that follows from faith.

God has prepared good works for us to do:

"For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus for good works, which God prepared beforehand, that we should walk in them."

Ephesians 2:10 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/eph.2.10.ESV>

The good works are those God has put in our life and those we will encounter each day. Will you choose to do good to them?

Here is a summary of Jesus' word⁴ that you are to do:

1. Feed the hungry
2. Clothe the naked
3. Give to the poor
4. Serve everyone
5. Do justly
6. Welcome strangers
7. Welcome the marginalized
8. Bring children to Jesus
9. Honor your parents
10. Tend and feed His sheep
11. Pray to overcome
12. Love your neighbors
13. Love your enemies
14. Be merciful
15. Visit prisoners
16. Visit the sick
17. Heal the sick
18. Proclaim the gospel
19. Give testimony
20. Make disciples

⁴ For scripture references on these commands of Jesus, see www.teams.church

We are to occupy ourselves doing God's word, causing His will to be done on earth as it is in heaven (Matthew 6:10). To do God's word is to be led by the Spirit, just as Christ was led by the Spirit (Luke 4:18-19, John 5:19, Acts 10:38).

Further, this is the kind of living that stirs up the Spirit within us (2 Timothy 1:6)! "For this is the love of God, that we keep his commandments..." (1 John 5:3).

God's plan to meet the needs of the world includes the regular, faithful good works of every member of His body, lay member or otherwise. Without their full and willing cooperation, those needs are not met.

Have you given over the room of your occupation to the Lordship of Jesus Christ?

When it comes to your occupation, open your hands to God and release it to Him.

Motivation

Does your motivation come from some good gift of God rather than God Himself?

With Christ as Lord, the motivation for our work is to be the same as His:

“I glorified you on earth, having accomplished the work that you gave me to do.”

John 17:4 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.17.4.ESV>

It is the glory of God. We are to reflect the majesty and splendor of God.

Like Jesus and like our Father (Luke 15:20), we are to be moved with compassion (Matthew 14:14). The compassion of Jesus hated evil enough to destroy it with the gospel of the kingdom (Acts 10:38, 1 John 3:8), and it loved people enough to act to meet their physical and spiritual needs (Matthew 4:23-24).

It's not possible for us to muster such motivation within us on our own. It's an outgrowth of the work of the indwelling Holy Spirit in our lives, because God is love (1 John 4:8).

When the Spirit of God has done His work in us, we abhor evil (Romans 12:9), and His love for others and for God is shed abroad in our hearts (Romans 5:5). Our chief characteristic is love (1 Corinthians 13:13), and it drives us to overcome evil with good (Romans 12:21). His love compels us to be zealous to do good works (Titus 2:14), just as our Lord Jesus was (Acts 10:38). It compels us to give and keep giving.

Have you given over the room of your motivation to the Lordship of Jesus Christ?

When it comes to your motivation, open your hands to God and release it to Him.

Interests

Often our interests lead us, because our time and attention tend to go more to the things that interest us. Further, the world we live in is full of distractions (Mark 4:14,19).

It should never be said Christ followers, as Paul said of most believers he knew, “For they all seek their own interests, not those of Jesus Christ.”

Philippians 2:21 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/php.2.21.ESV>

We should know that God’s will is not always done, for God has given to men and angels their own will.

As Christ followers, our new interest is to see all of God’s will done, for it is good: “Your kingdom come, your will be done, on earth as it is in heaven.”

Matthew 6:10 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/mat.6.10.ESV>

His kingdom is His government. It’s His rule in your life. It’s anywhere that God’s will is done.

Our good God “...is longsuffering to us-ward, not willing that any should perish, but that all should come to repentance.”

2 Peter 3:9b KJV

<https://bible.com/bible/1/2pe.3.9.KJV>

As those who have made Christ Lord,

“... it is God who works in you, both to will and to work for his good pleasure.”

Philippians 2:13 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/php.2.13.ESV>

Your interest is now to be found as a faithful one (Matthew 25:21) who does all of God’s will (Acts 13:22). God’s chief interest is to build up His family of sons and daughters while putting all evil under foot. So you must consecrate yourself to be single-minded and determined to see God’s will be done.

Your main interest should become God Himself. Nothing and no one is better, just as King David knew:

“I will bless the Lord at all times; his praise shall continually be in my mouth.”

Psalms 34:1 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/psa.34.1.ESV>

Have you given over the room of your interests to the Lordship of Jesus Christ?

When it comes to your interests, open your hands to God and release them to Him.

Let Him lead you! He is Jehovah Raah, the Lord my Shepherd.

Ability

The abilities we have right now are a blessing from God.

As those who have made Christ Lord in our lives, we should be familiar with the parable of the talents (Matthew 25:14-30). We are to make the most of what God has given us.

If we have made Christ Lord, we have His Spirit living in us as a downpayment of the life to come (2 Corinthians 1:21-22), along with spiritual abilities in areas of revelation, power, and inspiration (1 Corinthians 12:4-11). His word is true.

Considering these spiritual abilities, we should use what we are given and eagerly desire more (1 Corinthians 12:31, 1 Corinthians 14:1,12, Ephesians 4:7-12). The God we are connected to is El Shaddai, the All-Sufficient One, the Lord God Almighty. We are co-workers together with Him (Mark 16:20, 1 Corinthians 3:9, 2 Corinthians 6:1, Hebrews 2:4)! Working together with Him, He causes us to become channels of life to the world:

“Whoever believes in me, as the Scripture has said, ‘Out of his heart will flow rivers of living water.’”

John 7:38 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/jhn.7.38.ESV>

Have you given over the room of your ability to the Lordship of Jesus Christ?

When it comes to your ability, open your hands to God and release it to Him.

Identity

With Christ as your Lord, your identity is as a son of God (Romans 8:14), or daughter of God (2 Corinthians 6:18) with a full inheritance in Christ equal to that of a son (Romans 8:17). God delights in you!

That is who you are. You aren't defined by your other relationships or your job or any other position. You were purchased by Jesus' blood (Acts 20:28) to be a sibling of His, a child of God, predestined to be made like Jesus (Romans 8:29) in righteousness and holiness (Ephesians 4:23). God is Abba, our heavenly Father, just as Jesus called Him.

The Hope of Glory (Colossians 1:27) lives in you! You have His DNA (divine nature attributes, 2 Peter 1:3-8)!

If you believe yourself to be the children (sons) of God, it is time to act like it. Those living in darkness and bondage are waiting for us to do so (Matthew 9:35-38, Romans 8:19).

Have you given over the room of your identity to the Lordship of Jesus Christ?

When it comes to your identity, open your hands to God and release it to the One who created you.

He is Lord!

““Worthy are you, our Lord and God, to receive glory and honor and power, for you created all things, and by your will they existed and were created.””

Revelation 4:11 ESV

<https://bible.com/bible/59/rev.4.11.ESV>